

money—thousands of dollars, rather than hundreds—you've got to control the big killers. And whether you're working or retired, the big killers are the same: the huge house and the fancy car.

In a January 4, 1987, article in *The New York Times Magazine*, Richard B. Elsberry talks about what he calls his "preretirement" at age 53. Elsberry's piece is a personal, moving account of a retired life that makes sense for him. But in commenting on his new spending patterns, he says: "I've found that double coupons can cut the grocery bill 25 percent. I haunt tag sales and factory outlets for bargains. . . . And we subscribe to half as many magazines these days."

Like Mr. Elsberry, you can clip coupons, shop in factory outlets, and cancel magazines. If doing those things appeals to you, by all means do them. But in the scheme of things, saving \$50 on a magazine subscription doesn't help much when you're living in a \$3,000-a-month rental apartment. Saving \$100 in a factory outlet is a drop in the bucket when you're spending \$5,000 a month on mortgages and property taxes. You can scrimp and save for ten years in the supermarket, clipping coupons and stocking up on sale items. But if every year you spend \$20,000 on your vehicles, I can almost guarantee you'll never save much money.

Saving on housing and car costs is easy when you're retired. Chapter 5, for example, lists great places where you can live cheaply. Unfortunately, Nancy can't very well work in high-cost San Francisco and live in, say, a \$200-a-month rental in North Carolina. Similarly, retired people can get by with a cheap station car. If the cheap car refuses to run in the rain, retired people avoid driving in the rain. But Nancy needs her car to call on customers. She relies on her car, and a car that breaks down in the rain just won't do.

So Nancy will have a tougher time than retirees do in controlling housing and car costs. Still, Nancy *can* do a great deal to reduce those two killer costs.

Nancy lives in a \$2,500-a-month rental apartment on top of